Invoice Clearbook

User guide for accountants

From a folder of supplier invoices to bills in Xero, step by step

In one sentence: Invoice Clearbook reads your supplier invoices with an AI that runs on Missan's own computer, checks every number, lets you correct and approve each one, and then sends the approved bills to Xero for you. Nothing is sent to any outside AI service.

1. How it works: the big picture

Every invoice goes through the same six steps. You only act on three of them: you pick the folder, you check the invoice, and you click Approve. The rest happens by itself.

1. Run You pick a folder	**2. Reading** Automatic	**3. Review** You check	**4. Approve** You click	**5. Sent to Xero** Automatic	**6. Approve in Xero** Accountant, in Xero

Step	What happens	Who
1. Run	You choose a client and the folder where its invoices are (PDFs or photos).	You
2. Reading	Each file is read: the text, then the AI fills in supplier, number, dates, amounts and lines. Then the checks run (totals, VAT, dates, duplicates). About 3 to 4 minutes per invoice on the current computer.	Automatic
3. Review	You open each invoice from the Review queue, compare it with the page, fix what is wrong and choose the account for each line.	You
4. Approve	You click Approve. The invoice is checked once more and queued for Xero.	You
5. Sent to Xero	Within seconds the bill appears in Xero as **Awaiting approval**, with the original file attached.	Automatic
6. Approve in Xero	The accountant approves the bill in Xero as usual. Invoice Clearbook never approves or pays anything in Xero.	Accountant

Two approvals, on purpose. Approving in Invoice Clearbook means "this invoice was read correctly". Approving in Xero means "this bill goes into the books". The second one always stays with a person in Xero.

The screens

The menu on the left has three items:

Menu item	What it is for
Run	Start reading a folder of invoices, and watch the progress.
Review queue	The list of invoices waiting for you, most urgent first.
Clients	Each client's connection to Xero: connect, sync, send waiting bills.

At the top right you can switch between light and dark display (Light, Dark, or Match this computer).

2. Setting up a client (once per client)

A **client** is a business whose books you keep. Before its bills can go to Xero, the client is connected to its Xero organisation and its master data is brought in.

2.1 Create the client

1. Open **Run**.
2. In **Client**, type the new name under **New client name** and add it.

2.2 Connect Xero

1. Open **Clients**.
2. Next to the client, click **Connect Xero**.
3. Xero's sign-in page opens. Sign in, choose the client's organisation and click **Allow access**.
4. You come back to the Clients page with **Connected to Xero** and the organisation name.

2.3 Sync from Xero

1. On the Clients page, click **Sync from Xero** next to the client.
2. Invoice Clearbook brings in the client's **accounts** (chart of accounts), **VAT rates** and **suppliers** from Xero.
3. A summary shows what came in, and a table **VAT rates used for bills** shows how each Xero VAT rate is used here (for example Tax on Purchases = Standard 5%).

When to sync again: whenever someone adds or changes accounts, VAT rates or suppliers in Xero. It is not automatic yet: click **Sync from Xero** again. It is safe to click as often as you like; nothing is ever deleted (accounts removed in Xero just become inactive here).

2.4 Set default bill terms in Xero (recommended)

Xero refuses a bill without a due date, and many invoices do not print one. When the invoice has no due date, Invoice Clearbook uses the supplier's bill terms from Xero, or else the organisation's default bill terms. Set the default once in Xero:

1. In Xero: **Settings, Invoice settings, Default settings**.
2. Under **Bills Default Due Date**, choose for example "30 of the following month" or "30 days after the bill date". Save.

You can also set terms for one supplier on its contact in Xero; the supplier's terms win.

3. Step 1: Run a folder

1. Open **Run**.
2. Choose the **Client**.
3. Choose the place: the client's own folder, **This Mac**, or a shared drive.
4. Click into the folders until you reach the folder with the invoices. Sub-folders are included. The screen shows how many invoice files it found and an estimate of the time.
5. Set the **Folder date** if asked (the date the documents in this folder belong to).
6. Click **Start a run**.

> Files that were already read for this client are skipped automatically, so running the same folder again only reads the new files.

Watching the progress

The run page shows every file with its step: **Waiting**, **Read**, AI reading, **Checks**, done or **Failed**, and the **Time per step**. You do not have to wait: each invoice goes to the Review queue as soon as it is done, so you can start reviewing while the rest is still reading.

Button	What it does
Stop run	Files not started yet are not read. The file being read now finishes first. Nothing is lost.
Force stop now	Only after Stop: ends the AI read under way at once (that file will be read again when you resume).
Resume	Continues a stopped run where it stopped.
Retry	Reads a failed file again from the start.
Open review	Goes to the Review queue for this run.

4. Step 2: The Review queue

Open **Review queue** and choose the client. Invoices are sorted so the ones that need the most attention come first:

Category	Meaning	What to do
Exception	Something is wrong: an error must be fixed before approval (for example the totals do not add up, a TRN differs from the page, a possible duplicate).	Open it, fix the errors, then approve or reject.
Check	Readable, but something deserves a look (a warning: blurry photo, unusual date, value not found on the page).	Look at the warnings, then approve.
Ready	Everything checked out.	A quick look, then approve.

You can filter by run, category and search by supplier or invoice number. Click a row to open the invoice.

5. Step 3: Reviewing an invoice

The invoice page is on the **left** (zoom, fit width, page by page). What was read is on the **right**, as a form you can correct.

5.1 Start with the issues

- At the top, **Issues** lists everything the checks found. Click an issue to jump to its field.
- Red = error (must be fixed). Amber = warning (look, then decide).
- When you click into a field, the place where that value is printed is highlighted on the page, so you can compare quickly.
- Some issues offer a fix in one click, for example **Use printed value** when the TRN read differs from the one printed.

5.2 Check the header

- Supplier, supplier VAT registration no (TRN), invoice number, date, due date, currency, document type.
- **Due date:** leave it empty if the invoice does not print one. Xero's payment terms fill it in when the bill is sent (see 2.4).
- **Amounts are** (VAT included / VAT added / no VAT) is worked out from the amounts; change it only if it is clearly wrong.
- The totals check shows **Adds up** or **Does not add up** for subtotal + VAT = total.

5.3 Check the lines

- Each line has description, quantity, unit price and amount.
- For each line choose the **account** (from the client's Xero accounts) and the **VAT** rate. Suggestions are filled in when the supplier was coded before.
- Item codes and "5 x" at the start of descriptions are removed automatically when the page shows them elsewhere; a note above the lines says how many.
- If the total includes a charge printed outside the lines (delivery, service charge), a box offers **Add it as lines**.
- **Add line** and the bin icon add or remove lines.

5.4 Save, then approve

1. Click **Save & re-check**. The checks run again on your corrections and the issues list updates. (Messages stay as they were until you save.)
2. When no red errors are left, click **Approve**, or **Approve & next** to go straight to the next invoice in your list.

> Approve always takes the invoice **as last saved and checked**: never with unsaved edits or errors. If you leave the page with unsaved changes, it asks first.

5.5 When not to approve: Reject

Click **Reject document** and choose a reason:

- Duplicate: already in, or already posted

- Already entered in the accounting system by hand
- Belongs to another client
- Unreadable or incomplete
- Other (needs a note)

Quotes, purchase orders, statements and delivery notes are recognised and set aside as **Parked (not postable)**: they are never sent to Xero.

6. Step 4: Sending to Xero

After you approve a bill, sending is automatic. In a few seconds:

1. The accounts and VAT rates are checked against the client's Xero data.
2. The supplier is found in Xero (by its TRN or exact name), or created if it is new.
3. Xero is checked for the same supplier and invoice number, so a bill is never entered twice.
4. The bill is created in Xero as **Awaiting approval**, with the due date (printed, or from Xero's terms) and the original file attached.
5. A note is added to the bill's history: "Created by Missan invoice automation after review and approval in the Review Workbench."

Where to find it in Xero

Business, Bills to pay, Awaiting approval. Open the bill: the original invoice is under the attachments, and **History & Notes** at the bottom shows what was done and when ("System Generated" means it came through Invoice Clearbook).

When a bill comes back

If something stops a bill from going to Xero, it returns to the Review queue with a red box **Sent back: not posted** and the reason. Fix what it says and approve again.

The reason says	What to do
account ... is not in Xero's chart of accounts	Choose another account on that line (or add the account in Xero, then **Sync from Xero**).
no Xero VAT rate for this line's VAT type	Choose another VAT rate, or check the client's VAT rates in Xero and sync.
no due date is printed and Xero has no bill payment terms	Type the due date, or set default bill terms in Xero (section 2.4).
bill ... from this supplier is already in Xero	It was entered before: reject this one as a duplicate, or correct the invoice number if it was misread.
any other message from Xero	It is Xero's own words: fix that field and approve again.

Send waiting bills

On the **Clients** page, a client with approved bills not sent yet shows "N approved documents not posted yet" and a **Send waiting bills** button. Normally you never need it; it is there if bills were approved while the system was stopped.

Not sent to Xero yet: receipts (already paid by card or cash) and supplier credit notes. They stay counted as "not posted yet" until those are added. Clients without Xero are not sent either.

7. Problems and answers

What you see	Why	What to do
An invoice is not in the Review queue	It is still being read (about 3 to 4 minutes each), or the run was stopped.	Open Run and look at its progress; Resume if it was stopped.
A file shows Failed	The file could not be read (damaged, password, not an invoice file).	Click Retry. If it fails again, enter it by hand or reject it.
The account list is empty or old	Master data was not synced, or changed in Xero.	Clients, Sync from Xero.
Red messages stay after I fixed a line	They are from the last check.	Click Save & re-check.
Approve is refused	Errors remain, or there are unsaved edits.	Save & re-check, fix the red errors, approve.
Approved, but nothing in Xero after a minute	The system part that sends bills is not running, or the bill came back.	Look for Sent back in the queue; otherwise ask the person who runs the system, then use Send waiting bills.
The bill in Xero has no file	Xero would not take the file (over 10 MB or a type it refuses).	The bill's note says so; attach it by hand in Xero if needed. The original stays in Missan's folders.
Description still has a number at the start	Only removed when the page proves it is a code or the quantity.	Edit the description if you want it shorter.

Golden rules

- **Compare with the page.** The AI is good, not perfect: the checks catch most mistakes, your eyes catch the rest.
- **Never guess.** If a value is not on the invoice, leave it empty.
- **Save & re-check before approving** after any change.
- **Sync from Xero** when accounts or suppliers change there.
- **The final approval is in Xero.** Invoice Clearbook only prepares bills as Awaiting approval.

8. Words used in this guide

Word	Meaning
Client	A business whose books Missan keeps.
Run	One reading of a folder of invoices for one client.
Master data	The client's accounts, VAT rates and suppliers, brought in from Xero.
Account	A line of the chart of accounts, for example 429 General Expenses.
TRN	UAE Tax Registration Number: 15 digits, shown on screen as VAT registration no.
Exception / Check / Ready	How much attention an invoice needs: errors / warnings / none.
Approve (Invoice Clearbook)	"Read correctly, send it to Xero."
Awaiting approval	The Xero status of bills we send: waiting for the accountant's approval in Xero.
Sent back	A bill that could not go to Xero, back in review with the reason.
Parked (not postable)	A quote, order, statement or delivery note: kept, never sent.
Receipt	A document already paid by card or cash (sent to Xero in a later version).

For the person who runs the system

Invoice Clearbook runs on Missan's computer. To start it, open a terminal in the project folder and start each part in its own tab:

```
make up     # database and job queue
make migrate
ollama serve  # the AI model (skip if already running)
make api    # the service the screens talk to
make worker # reads invoices and sends bills: run only ONE
make web    # the screens: http://127.0.0.1:5173
```

After a software update, restart **make worker** (Ctrl+C, then make worker again).